



04: Analysing and Representing User Data

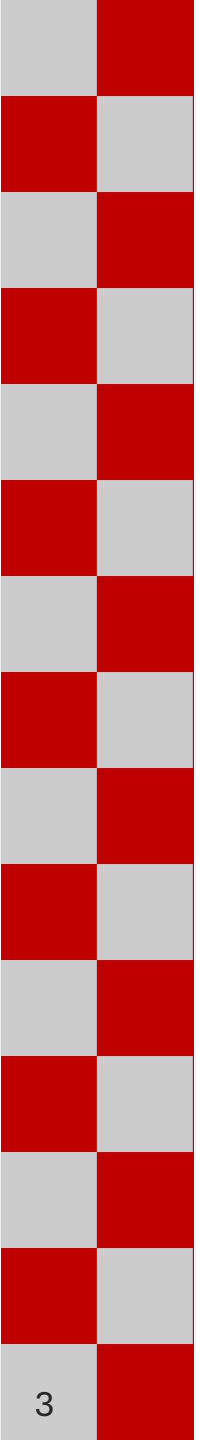
IN3065/INM355 | 2025–2026
User-Centred System Design

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Session 4: **Learning objectives**



- By completing this session, including any practical activity and assigned readings, you should be able to:
 - Analyse user research data using affinity diagrams.
 - Synthesise empathy maps from user data.
 - Construct and interpret user journey maps.
 - Create effective personas to inform design.
 - *Optional: Use task analysis and modelling to represent users' activities*



Analysing and representing data

Why do we need to analyse & represent data?

We may have lots of data, from evaluations and user research, in a variety of formats.

- Need to provide evidence for findings.
- Need to communicate findings with others.
- Need to distill findings into a format that is easily understood and quick to grasp.
- Need to reflect on findings to provide recommendations.

Using the data we collect

- The findings from user research are used to inform design.
- To do this, we collect, analyse, organise and represent data in various ways.
- These representations include empathy maps, user journey maps, task models, personas, ...amongst others.
- Note: We can often represent the same information in different ways
 - the choice of representation may or may not be up to you.
- Representations don't just *summarise* research.
 - They present it in a form that is *usable* during the design process.

Different **types** of data



Qualitative data : Very rich / detailed, e.g. comments in interviews, think-aloud transcripts, images, video, etc.

Quantitative data : Things that can be turned into numbers or frequencies, e.g. scales, task measures.

- Data collection and analysis even may produce both:
 - e.g. an interview captures qualitative data that is later transformed into quantitative data, (frequency of themes noted).
 - e.g. a questionnaire that has quantitative data from Likert scale questions measuring attitude/opinion, and may also have qualitative data in answers to open questions.
 - e.g. an observation that has quantitative ‘task success’ data, but also qualitative ‘think aloud’ data, providing insight into the reasons for task success/failure.

Analysis with a **purpose**

It's important to know why you're doing the analysis:

- To describe users, for informing design?
- To identify problems with a view to fixing them?
- To identify opportunities for design?
- To identify needs, requirements or constraints?
- To represent user tasks?



Analysing & representing data:

Simple analysis approaches



Simple **quantitative** analysis

- Usually for questionnaire data, or some observation data.
- Calculate descriptive statistics
 - Counts, averages, standard deviations
 - e.g. average age of participants, or average rating for a scale question.
- Run statistical tests – e.g. t-test, ANOVA, Pearson's correlation
 - But only if the sample size is big enough
- Produce graphs of descriptive statistics e.g. bar graph, pie chart, etc.
- Always consider how to describe these data appropriately.
 - e.g. don't report percentages for small numbers of participants.
- Tools: Excel, SPSS

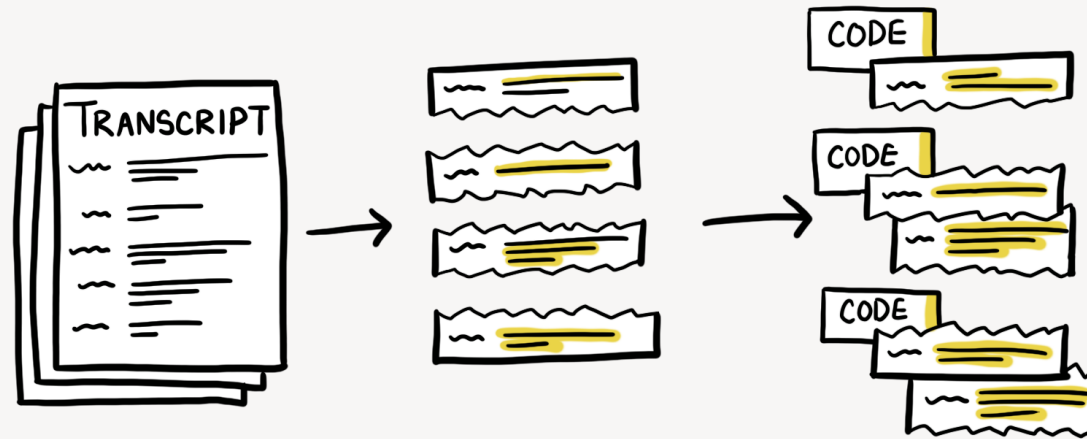


Simple **qualitative** analysis

You can try some “coding”, e.g. through simple thematic analysis.

1. Familiarise yourself with the qualitative data you gathered.
 2. Look for recurring patterns in your data, e.g. similar things people say, do or describe.
 - Inductive or deductive.
 3. “Code” the data accordingly, i.e. mark up the parts of the text (or speech) where these patterns are observed.
 4. Review your coding—iterate and adjust.
 5. Look for potential themes, within your coding, that may be relevant to your project.
 6. You can also turn this into simple frequencies, e.g. to check the prevalence / importance of codes/themes within the data.
- See also: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/thematic-analysis>

Simple qualitative analysis: 'coding'



from <https://delvetool.com/learn>

Interview extract

Personally, I'm not sure. I think the climate is changing, sure, but I don't know why or how. People say you should trust the experts, but who's to say they don't have their own reasons for pushing this narrative? I'm not saying they're wrong, I'm just saying there's reasons not to 100% trust them. The facts keep changing – it used to be called global warming.

Codes

- Uncertainty
- Acknowledgement of climate change
- Distrust of experts
- Changing terminology

I like to be proactive when finding inspiration; as it's a significant factor in my creative process. I use a variety of platforms to follow designers who inspire me and also browse magazines, industry-specific publications, books and even films. I've found that inspiration can come from the most unexpected places, such as a walk in the woods, and even though I know and follow a core set of designers, I also try to expand my awareness.

My portfolio shows my skills in recording and editing videos. I've included recent work that I think captures the essence of the client's brief. This project, in particular, shows my technical skills in adding animation to videos while also clearly expressing the nature of the client's products. I'm most comfortable working with graphic design systems and have experience with several platforms. As I am currently freelancing, I've learned to adapt swiftly to clients' requests. Recent platforms I've worked with include InDesign and Photoshop.

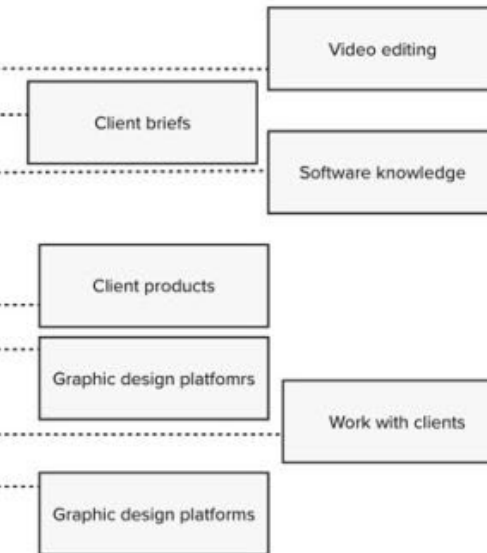
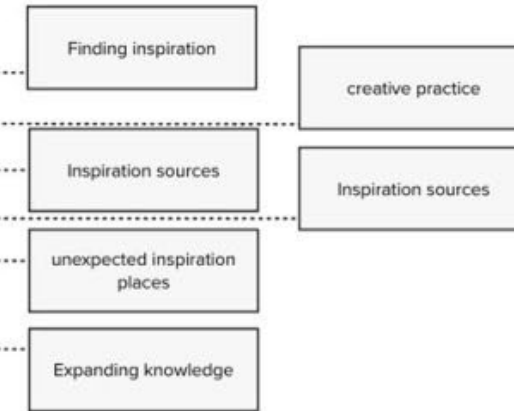


Image source:
<https://www.designorate.com/what-is-thematic-analysis-and-how-to-apply-in-design-thinking>

INTERVIEWER: So, what do you think of the current strategies to prevent road traffic collisions and neurotrauma in your city and country?

Codes

PARTICIPANT: You know, the government has instituted things like traffic rules and all that, but these are not being enforced properly. There don't seem to be enough traffic police to cover the many areas in the city where there is a lot of traffic, and I suppose what you could call accident-prone areas. I have read on the internet that many other countries are having things like speed cameras and all that to prevent speeding. I know we have things like speed bumps and maybe the signs which show the speed limit. The problem is people are not following the rules. For that reason, it would be good to have these speed cameras, for example, so that people will realise that some enforcement is being carried out. The other thing is that

Gov. role

Lack of compliance

Lack of enforcement

Accident reduction

strategies

Lack of compliance

Accident reduction

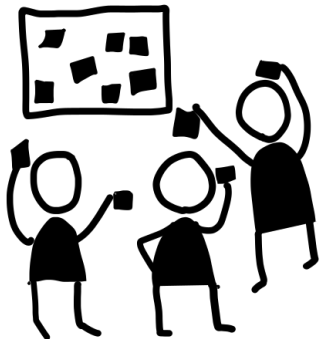
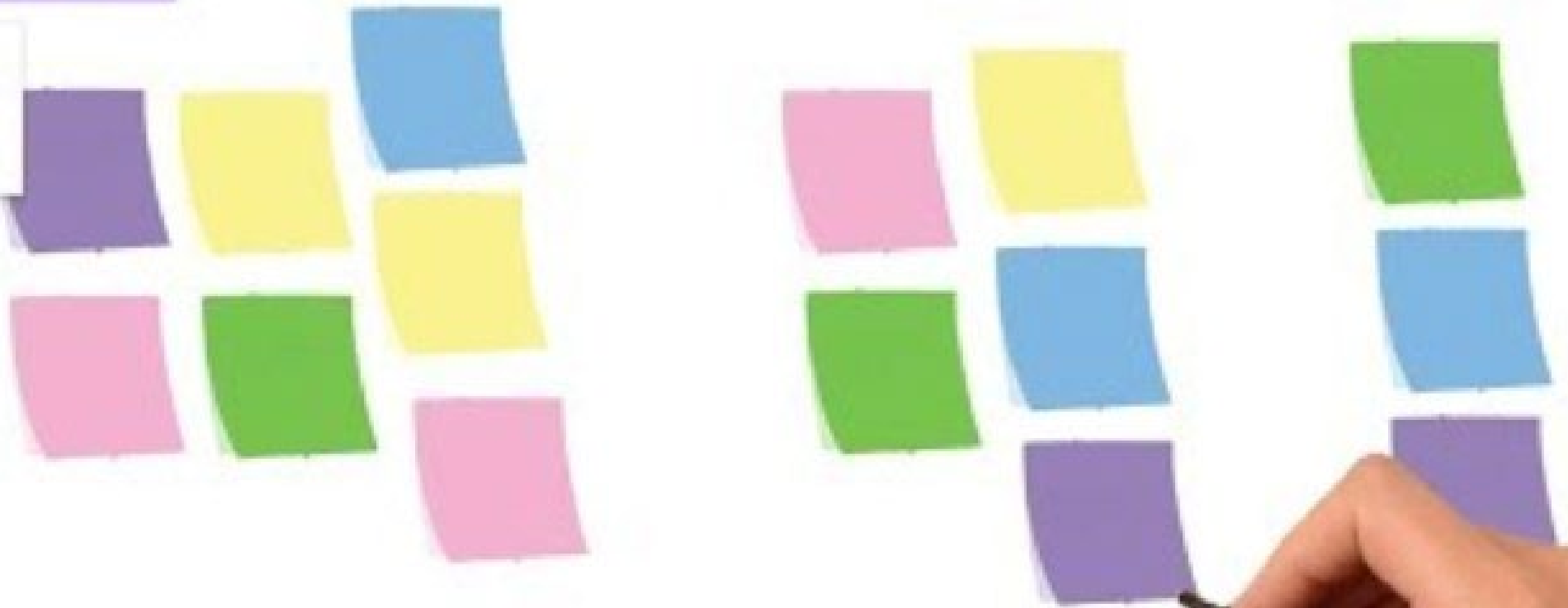
strategies

Affinity mapping



Affinity

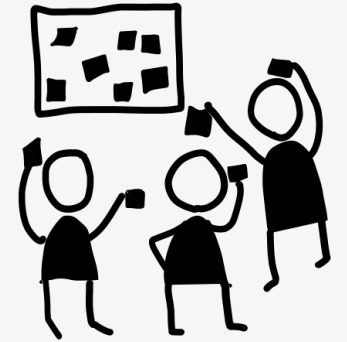
Map



Affinity mapping

https://youtu.be/R_vLlaUYHSo?t=35

Affinity Mapping



Organising data into groups or themes that are useful.

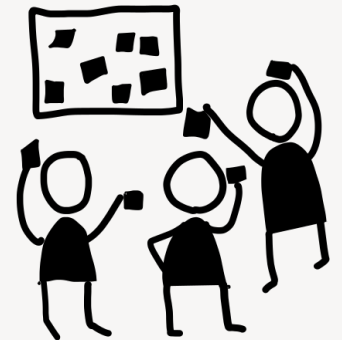
After research has been conducted:

1. Write out important details or insights (e.g. activities/tasks, attitudes, aptitudes, motivations, skills) from the research onto individual sticky notes.
2. Group the sticky notes into categories you feel make sense.
3. Adjust the categories as new details / insights are uncovered.
4. Review the categories and use them to inform design insights.
5. Keep a record of the categories and their content, for future reference and to show the origin of any design ideas generated.

See also: <https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/article/affinity-diagrams-learn-how-to-cluster-and-bundle-ideas-and-facts>

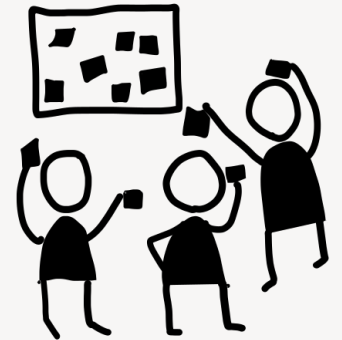
Affinity Mapping: a **flexible** analysis method

- Can be done as a team
- Can be done individually
- Can be done in-person, using sticky notes
- Can be done digitally, using tools like Miro or Figjam or LucidChart
- Can use colour for different purposes
 - Different users
 - Different interview questions



What is Affinity Mapping **useful** for?

- Analysing data from interviews, or observations.
- Extracting themes and insights.
- Synthesising research.
- Good for identifying patterns, e.g. related to users.
- Good for identifying requirements.
- Good for understanding priorities.
- Can be helpful in generating personas.
- Can be helpful in ideation.
- In evaluation, it's also helpful for synthesising findings from usability testing.



What are the problems with the way our team runs meetings?

Timing

Some meetings are too short and feel rushed

Some meetings are too long and drag on forever

Some recurring meetings are unnecessary

Too many meetings are scheduled during peak work hours/busy times

Focus

Too many meetings don't have an agenda or clear goal

People jump in with tangents or unnecessary topics

Meetings don't have a facilitator to keep the conversation on track

Attendees

Meetings have too many attendees

Involved in too many meetings I don't need to be a part of

Lack of clarity about what each person should contribute

Not sure why I would want to share something from an app.
(Participant A)

Eva Schicker

Confused about the star icon.
(Participant A)

Eva Schicker

Share button is unclear.
(Participant B)

Eva Schicker

Homepage is not intuitive.
(Participant B)

Eva Schicker

Share is ok, but not needed maybe?
(Participant C)

Eva Schicker

The event listings don't mean anything.
(Participant C)

Eva Schicker

The type is really small. I almost did not see it at first. (Participant A)

Eva Schicker

Finds it difficult that the homepage is not scrollable.
(Participant A)

Eva Schicker

The type is just so small. Can't read it.
(Participant B)

Eva Schicker

There should be a title for the bio list on the home page.
(Participant C)

Eva Schicker

I would like some kind of label that says 'favorite'.
(Participant C)

Eva Schicker

Need confirmation on send / share.
(Participant D)

Eva Schicker

Customize the app by favoriting my artists.
(Participant D)

Eva Schicker

Type on screen is illegible, especially in captions.
(Participant E)

Eva Schicker

Wishes the bios would be scrollable.
(Participant E)

Eva Schicker

Artist of the week is confusing.
(Participant E)

Eva Schicker

Listings in Happening Today should be scrollable.
(Participant D)

Eva Schicker

I don't really know how to look for an event.
(Participant D)

Eva Schicker

Charlie's page is a bit confusing to find.
(Participant E)

Eva Schicker

Comfortable with the scrolling info.
(Participant E)

Eva Schicker



Scrollability

Comfortable with the scrolling info.
(Participant E)

Finds it difficult that the homepage is not scrollable.
(Participant A)

Tries to scroll the home screen.
(Participant A)

Listings in Happening Today should be scrollable.
(Participant D)

Bio pics on the homepage should be scrollable.
(Participant B)

Clarification of headers

The headers need to be worded more appropriately.
(Participant A)

There should be a title for the bio list on the home page.
(Participant B)

The event listings don't mean anything.
(Participant C)

There should be a title for the bio list on the home page.
(Participant C)

There needs to be a date for the event.
(Participant B)

Confusion in general

I don't really know how to look for an event.
(Participant D)

Homepage is not intuitive.
(Participant B)

Charlie's page is a bit confusing to find.
(Participant E)

The star icon by itself doesn't really do much.
(Participant B)

Hesitant at first on the home page.
(Participant D)

Artist of the week is confusing.
(Participant E)

Confused about the star icon.
(Participant A)

Type legibility

It's a bit difficult to see at first what's what.
(Participant D)

The type is really small. I almost did not see it at first.
(Participant A)

The type is just so small. Can't read it.
(Participant B)

Type is just so small.
(Participant C)

Type on screen is illegible, especially in captions.
(Participant E)

'Favorite' label approval

I would like some kind of label that says 'favorite'.
(Participant E)

A 'favorite' label would be helpful.
(Participant C)

Customize the app by favoriting my artists.
(Participant D)

Content sharing improvements

Share button is unclear.
(Participant B)

Not sure why I would want to share something from an app.
(Participant A)

Need confirmation on send / share.
(Participant D)

I'm not sure I'd share this information by email.
(Participant D)

Share is ok, but not needed maybe?
(Participant C)

1

Type legibility



All participants struggled with the type being too small for readability.

2

Content sharing improvements



4 out of 5 participants asked for clarification on the share button functionality.

3

Clarification of headers



3 out of 5 participants asked for headers, especially event headers, be more clearly written.

4

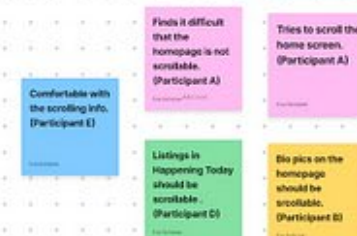
Confusion in general



4 out of 5 participants experienced some type of confusion while using the app.

5

Scrollability



4 out of 5 participants favor scrolling to access more in-depth content.

6

'Favorite' label approval



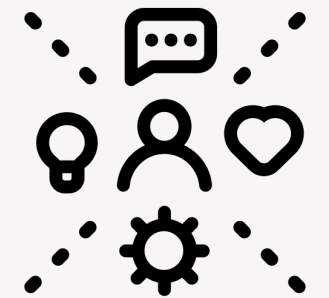
3 out of 5 participants appreciated a 'favorite' label for customization.

Questions?



Analysing & representing data

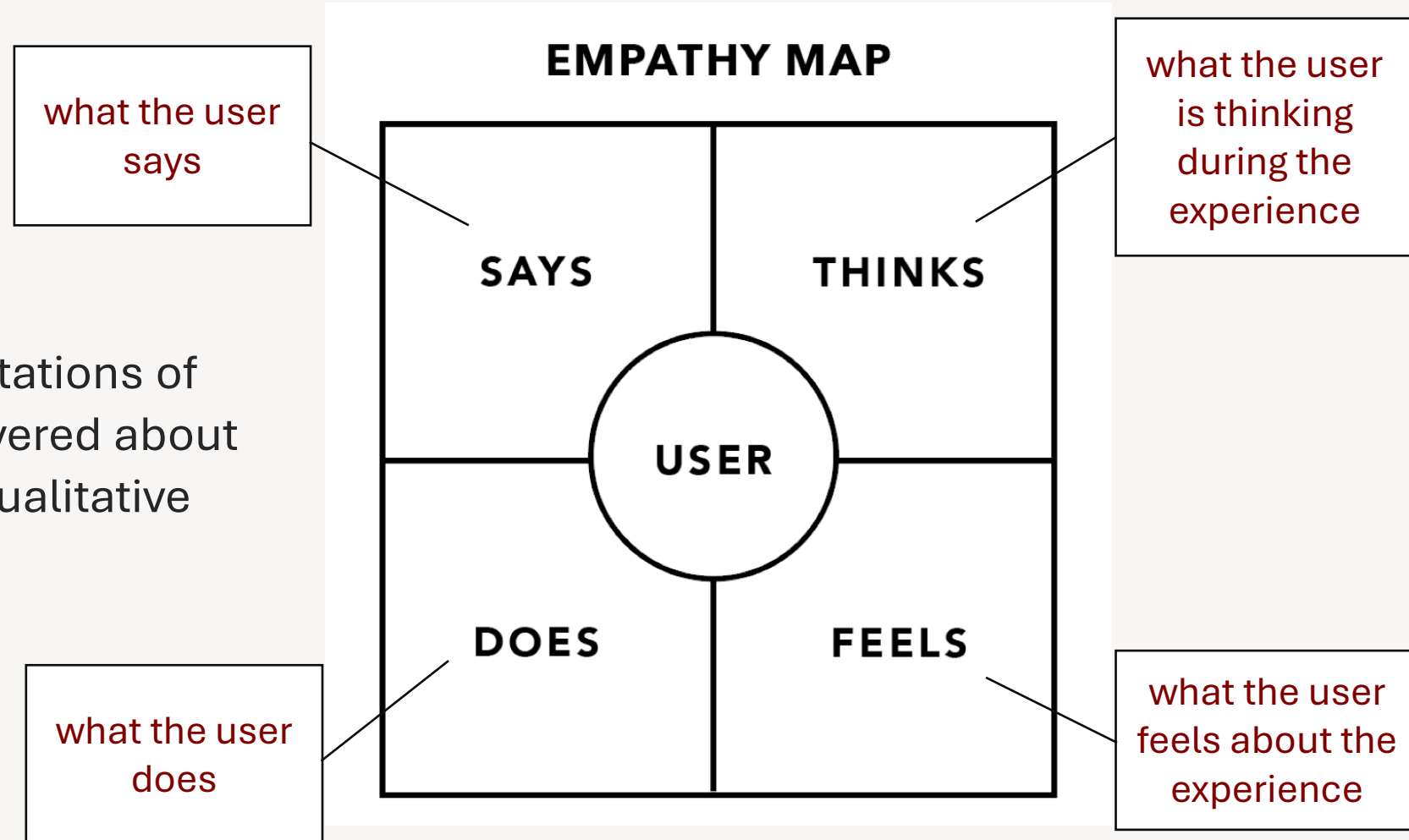
Empathy Maps



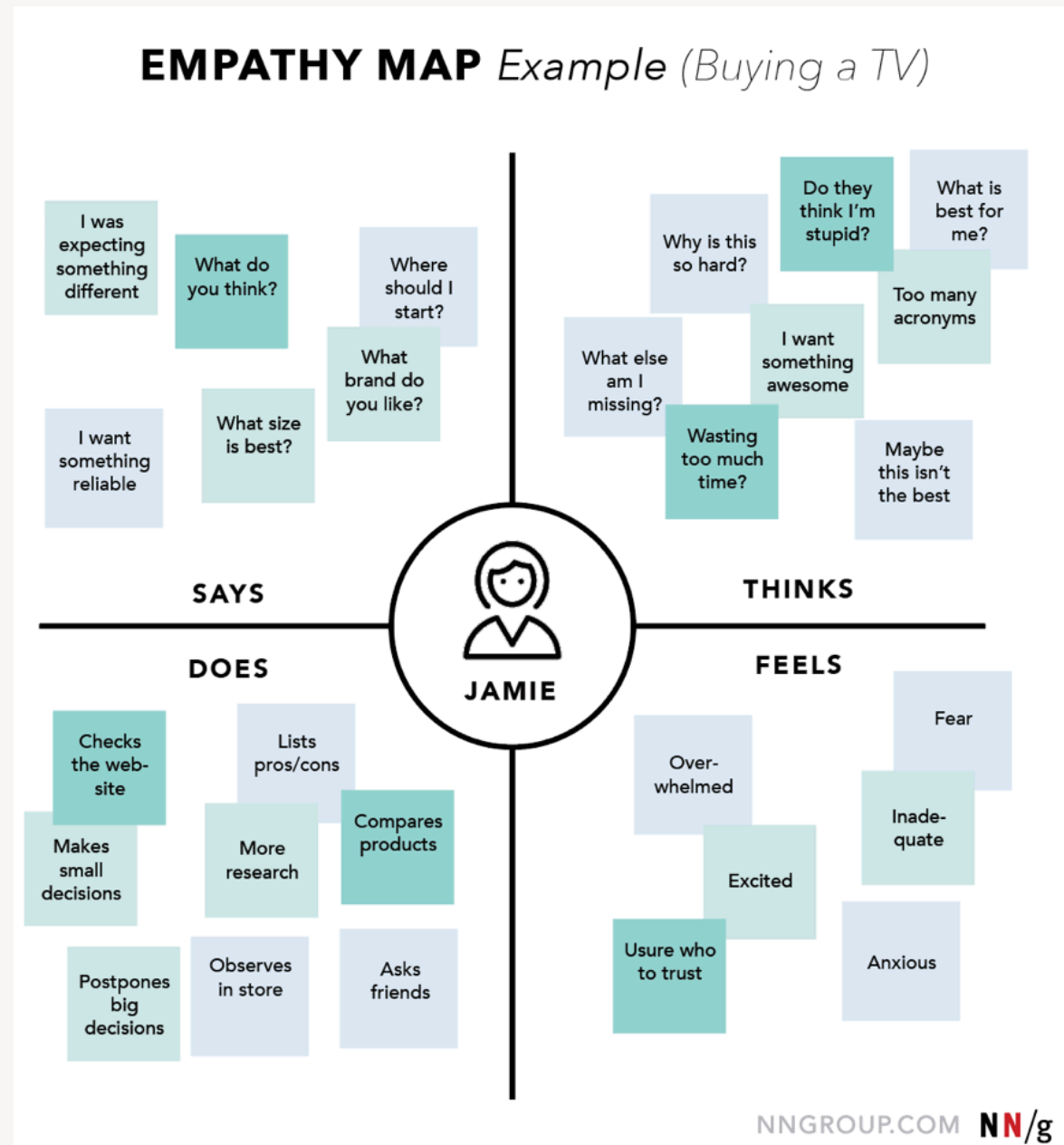
Empathy maps

Empathy Maps

Descriptive representations of what you have discovered about the user(s) through qualitative research.



Empathy Maps



From: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/empathy-mapping>

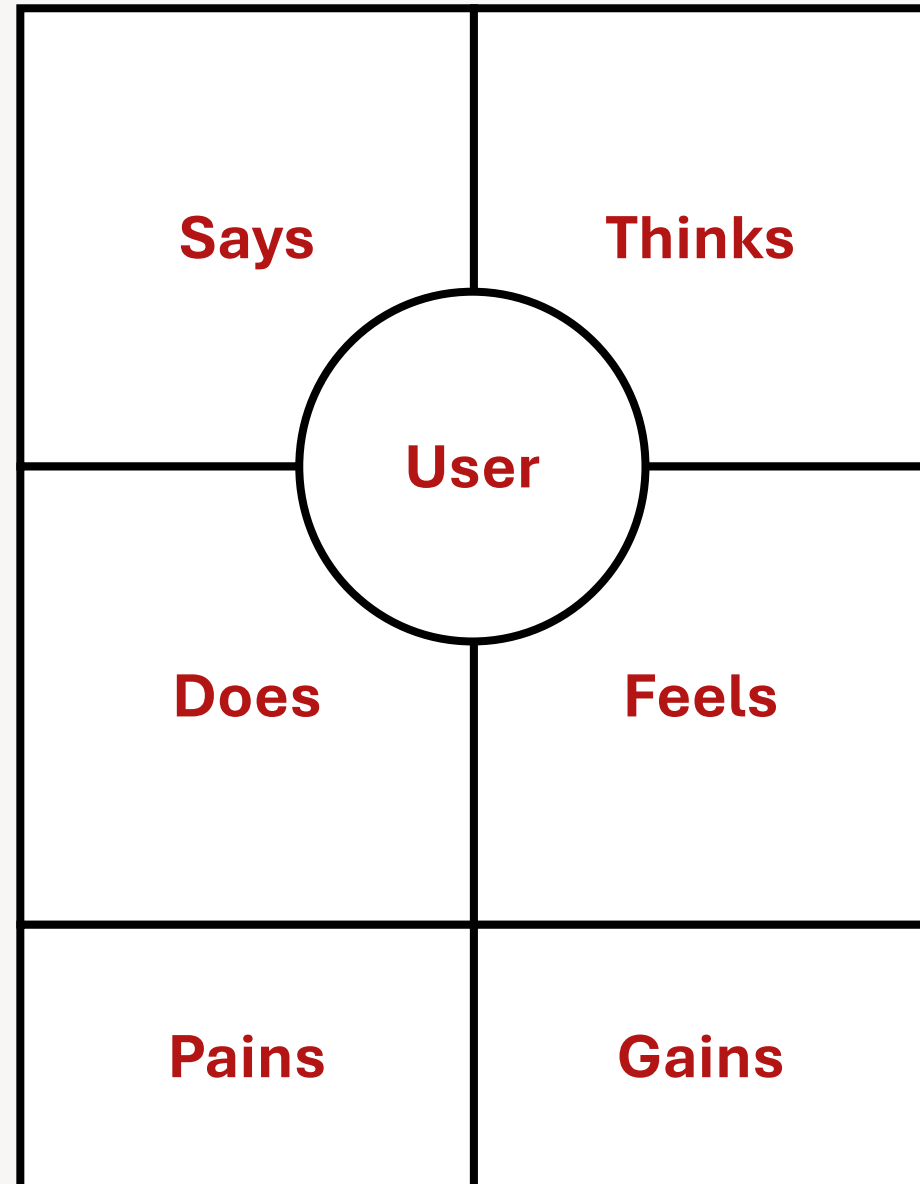
Empathy Maps

Pains

- E.g. fears, frustrations, obstacles, difficulties, annoyances, challenges...

Gains

- Goals, hopes, measures of success...

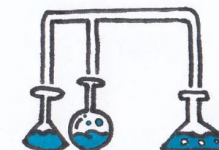




MAPPING THE USERS' THOUGHTS,
NEEDS, MOTIVATIONS, FEELINGS
ATTITUDES, BELIEFS, ISSUES

EMPATHY MAP

UX Knowledge Base Sketch #12



WAY TO SYNTHESIZE
RESEARCH DATA TO BETTER
UNDERSTAND THE USERS



- GREAT TEAM EXERCISE
- VISUALIZE USERS' NEEDS
- GOOD STARTING POINT
- QUICK & COST-EFFICIENT

CREATE A MAP FOR
EACH PERSONA
(/CUSTOMER SEGMENT)



AFTER
COLLECTING
RESEARCH DATA

PRODUCT DESIGN
TIMELINE



BEFORE DEFINING
THE PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS



THERE ARE
DIFFERENT
TEMPLATES

OTHER ASPECTS /WORDING
FOR EXAMPLE:

- TASKS
- INFLUENCES
- QUOTES
- GOALS



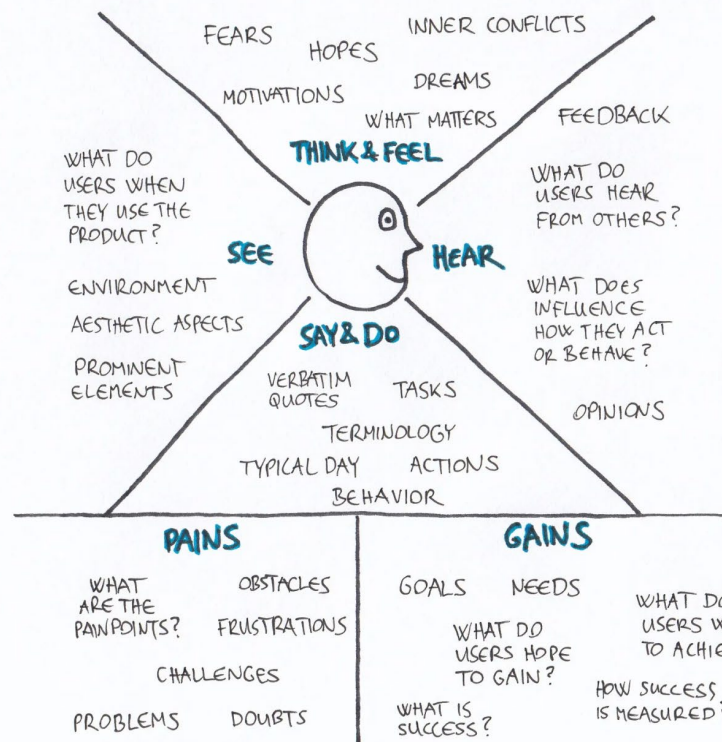
PREREQUISITES:

- UX RESEARCH DATA
- PERSONAS



DON'T FORGET TO
DOCUMENT THE SESSION!

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PARTICIPANTS
OF THE MAPPING

- ↳ CORE TEAM MEMBERS
- ↳ OPTIONAL: STAKEHOLDERS



TOOLS FOR THE
MAPPING SESSION

- ↳ WHITEBOARD OR PRINTED OUT MAPS
- ↳ STICKY NOTES & PENS/MARKERS



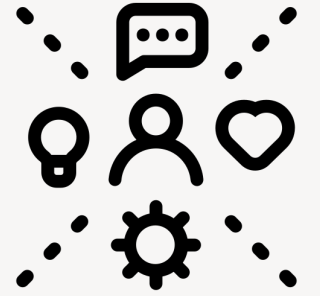
PREPARE THE DATA
YOU'VE COLLECTED
FROM THE RESEARCH
(E.G. USER INTERVIEWS
CONTEXTUAL INQUIRY
ONLINE SURVEY
TESTIMONIALS &
OTHER FEEDBACK)

Creating Empathy Maps

To create an empathy map, follow these steps:

1. Collect qualitative data about users.
2. Review data for each user to pull out findings for each segment (sticky notes can help).
3. Organise on the empathy map.

An empathy map can represent a single user **or** an aggregation of users: you can start with multiple individual maps and then aggregate.



Empathy maps

Empathy Maps uses

- Use to **organise findings** from user research.
- Use as a collaborative tool to **create common ground** in the design team.
- Use to **create empathy** during subsequent design activities and to help with decision making.

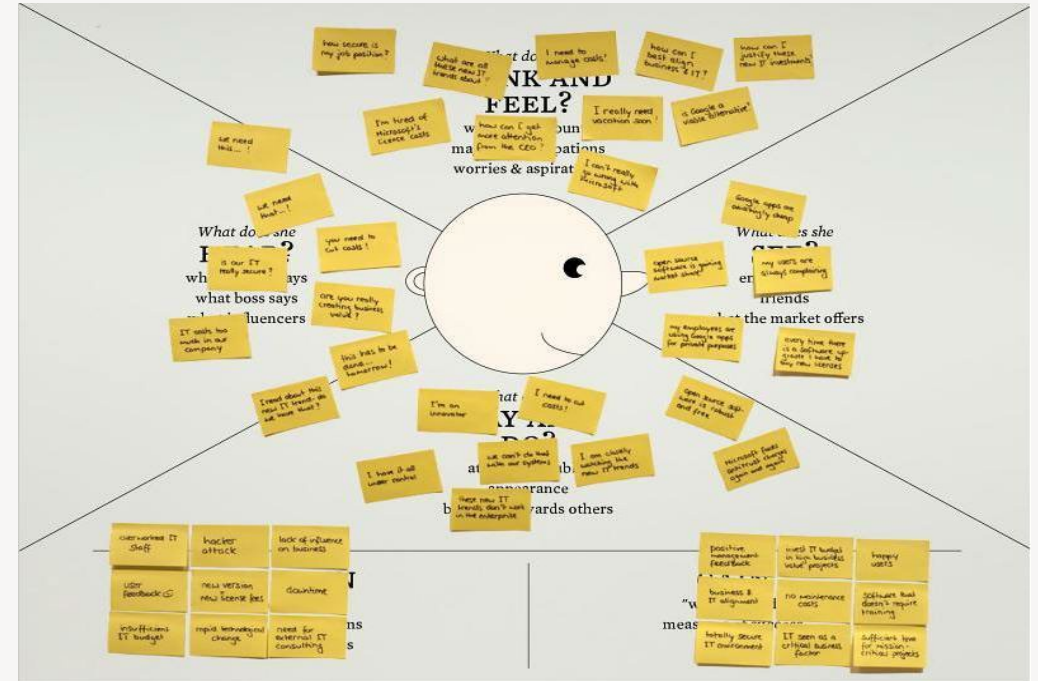


Image from Osterwalder and Pigneur (2010) Business Model Generation.
Adapted from <https://xplane.com/worksheet/empathy-map-worksheet/>

Empathy Maps: **Pros, Cons, watchpoints**

Pros

- Easy technique to learn and use.
- Organises detailed qualitative data from real people.
- Can represent single user or aggregated types/segments.

Cons

- Can become unmanageable if contain a lot of data.
- Overlaps can be frustrating.
- Can be harder to populate some quadrants from certain types of research.
- Important detail not always represented, e.g. chronology.
- More organisation & representation than analysis.

Watchpoints

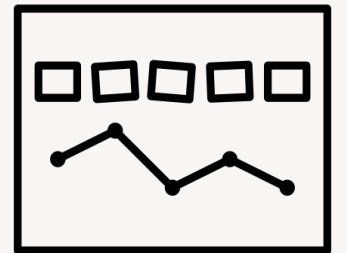
- Represent the data, not what the researcher assumes/infers.
- If you want certain types of data (e.g. feelings), make sure you capture it.

Questions?



Analysing and representing data

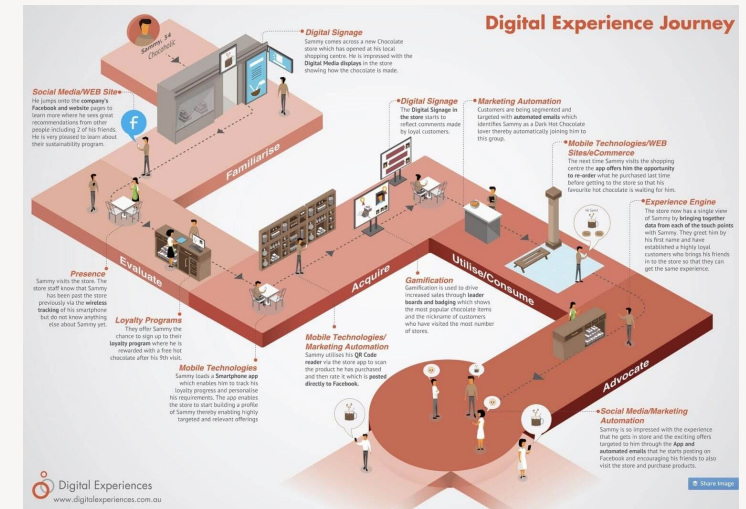
User Journey Maps



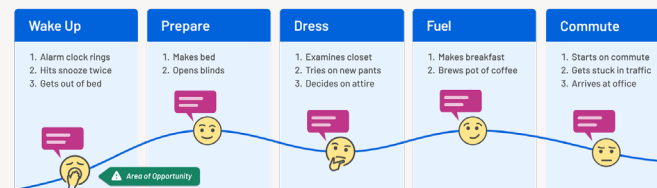
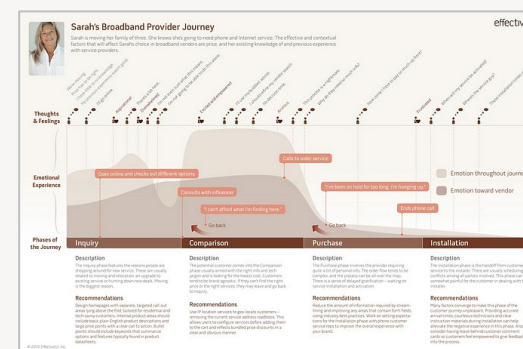
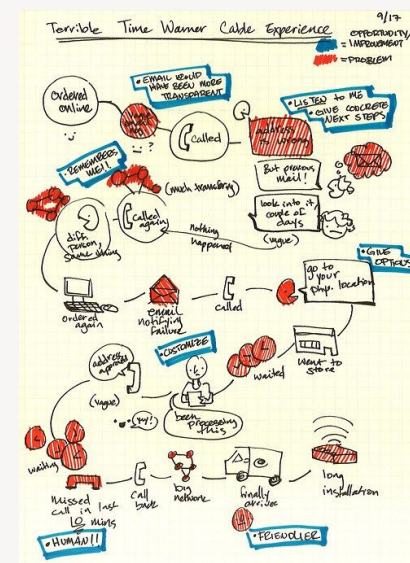
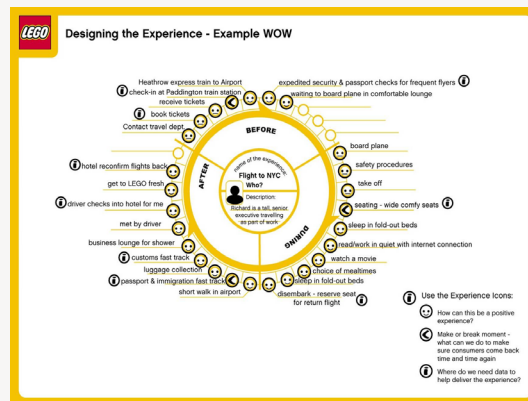
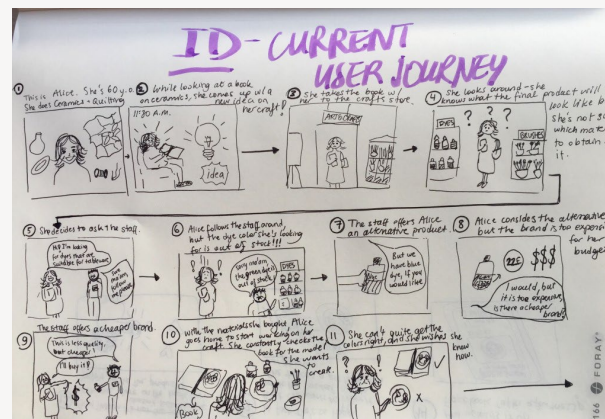
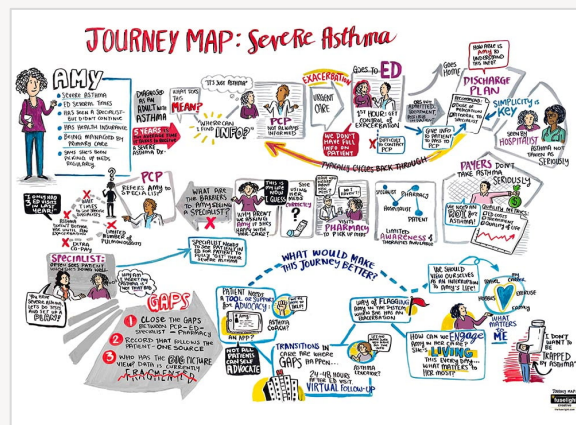
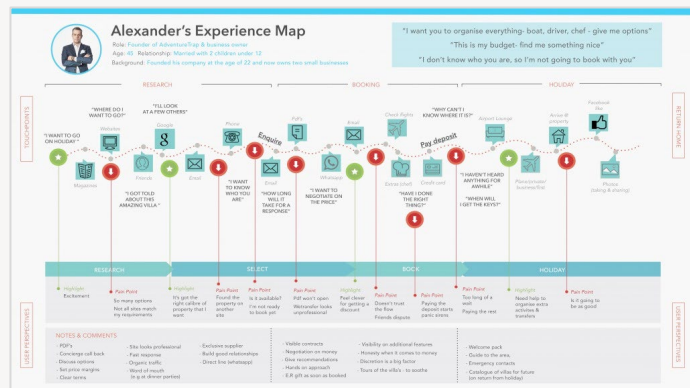
User Journey Maps

What is a 'user journey'?

- A user journey is the **end-to-end experience** a person goes through, as they try to achieve a goal
- Sequence of steps over time.
- From a starting point, towards a particular goal/outcome.
- Usually involving the use of some kind of system or service ... or the potential for one.
- A **user journey** is the **experience** itself, not a particular diagram.
- A **user journey map** is just one way of representing that experience.



Representing user journeys



Images: <https://thefuselight.com/services/journey-mapping/>
<https://strategicmanagementinsight.com/tools/customer-journey-map>
<https://www.thisisservicesdesigndoing.com/methods/mapping-journeys>
<https://openfieldx.com/ux-discovery-activities-user-journey-mapping>
<https://boagworld.com/audio/customer-journey-mapping/>

User Journey Maps

- Also ‘User Experience Journey Maps’, ‘Customer Experience Journey Maps’.
- Used to represent what users do to achieve a goal
 - **Current** user journey maps (aka ‘as-is’)
 - What users do **now** (*user research*)
 - **Future** user journey maps:
 - What users might do **in the future** (*conceptual design / envisionment*)

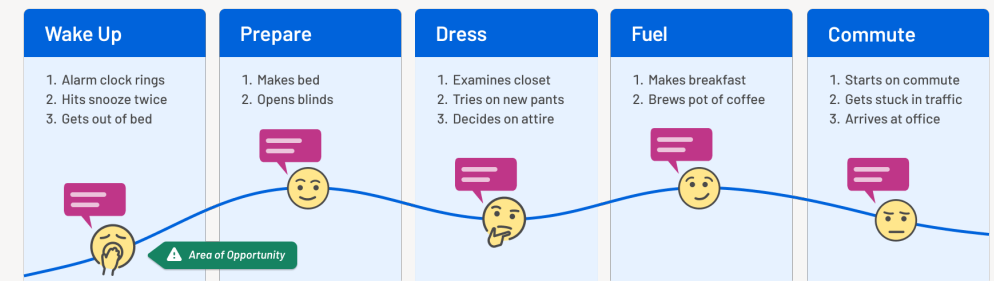


Image: <https://openfieldx.com/ux-discovery-activities-user-journey-mapping/>

What is in a User Journey Map?

- Represent a specific **sequence** of user activities; doesn't show all possible sequences.
- Shows interactions with different **touchpoints**; doesn't describe them in detail.
- Shows **context** and user's **emotions**.
- Can be high-level (all touchpoints for a product) or a very specific scenario.

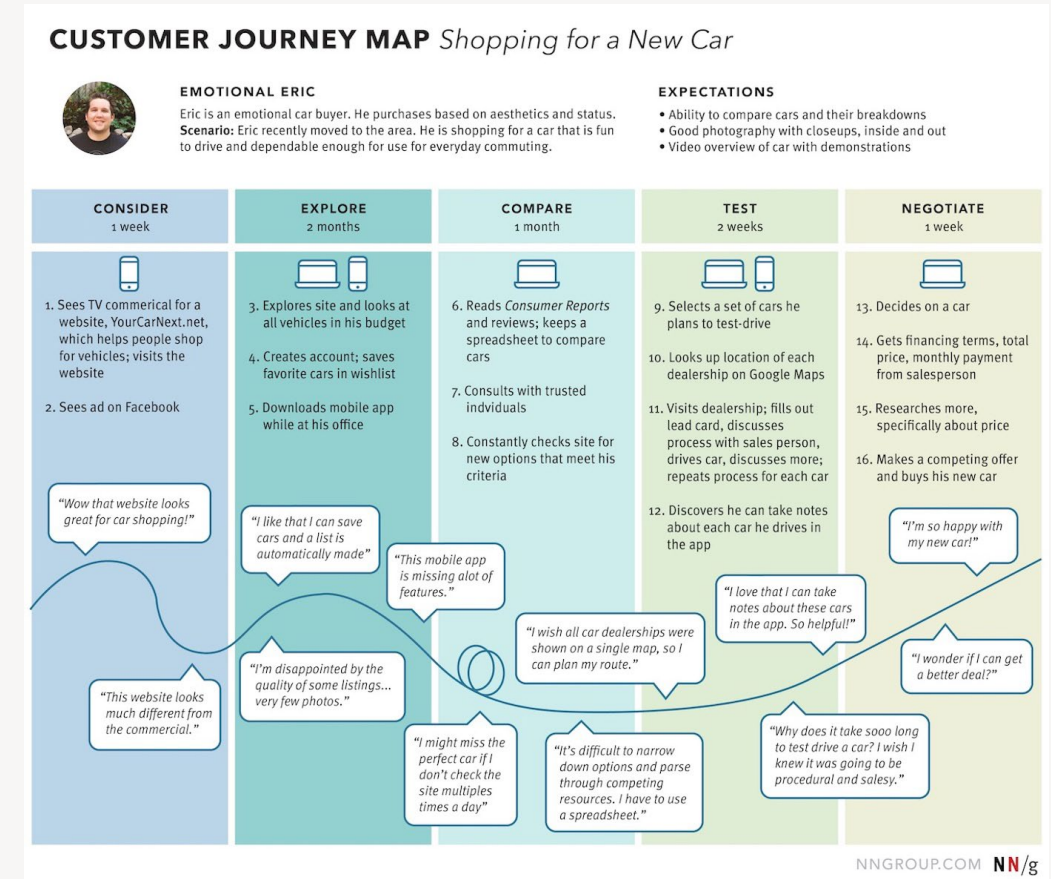


Image: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/analyze-customer-journey-map>

What is in a User Journey Map?

Context : Where is the user? What is around them? Are any external factors impacting their use of the system?

Progression : How does each step enable the user to get to the next?

Devices : What technology are they using? What features does it have?

Functionality : What features / functionality are they using?

Emotion : What is the user's emotional state in each step? Are they engaged, bored, annoyed?

Pain points : What frustrations, challenges or difficulties do they experience?

Opportunities : What opportunities for improvement might there be—to address a problem / pain point, or enhance things?

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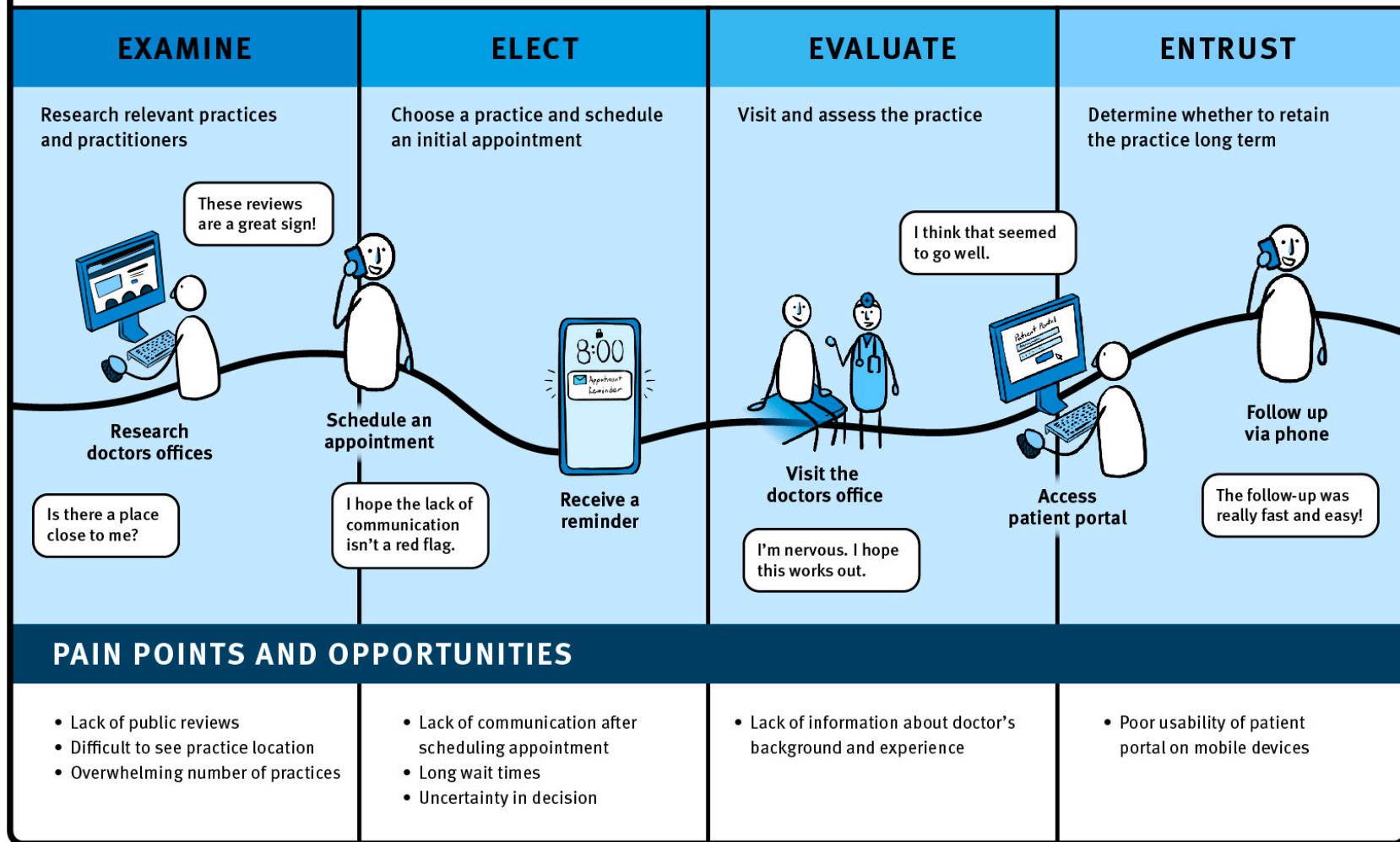


NEWCOMER NELSON

Scenario: Newcomer Nelson is new to town and wants to find a medical practice to use long term for general care.

EXPECTATIONS

- Local, convenient physical location
- High level of doctor expertise and experience
- Friendly, prompt communications and staff interactions



CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP *Shopping for a New Car*

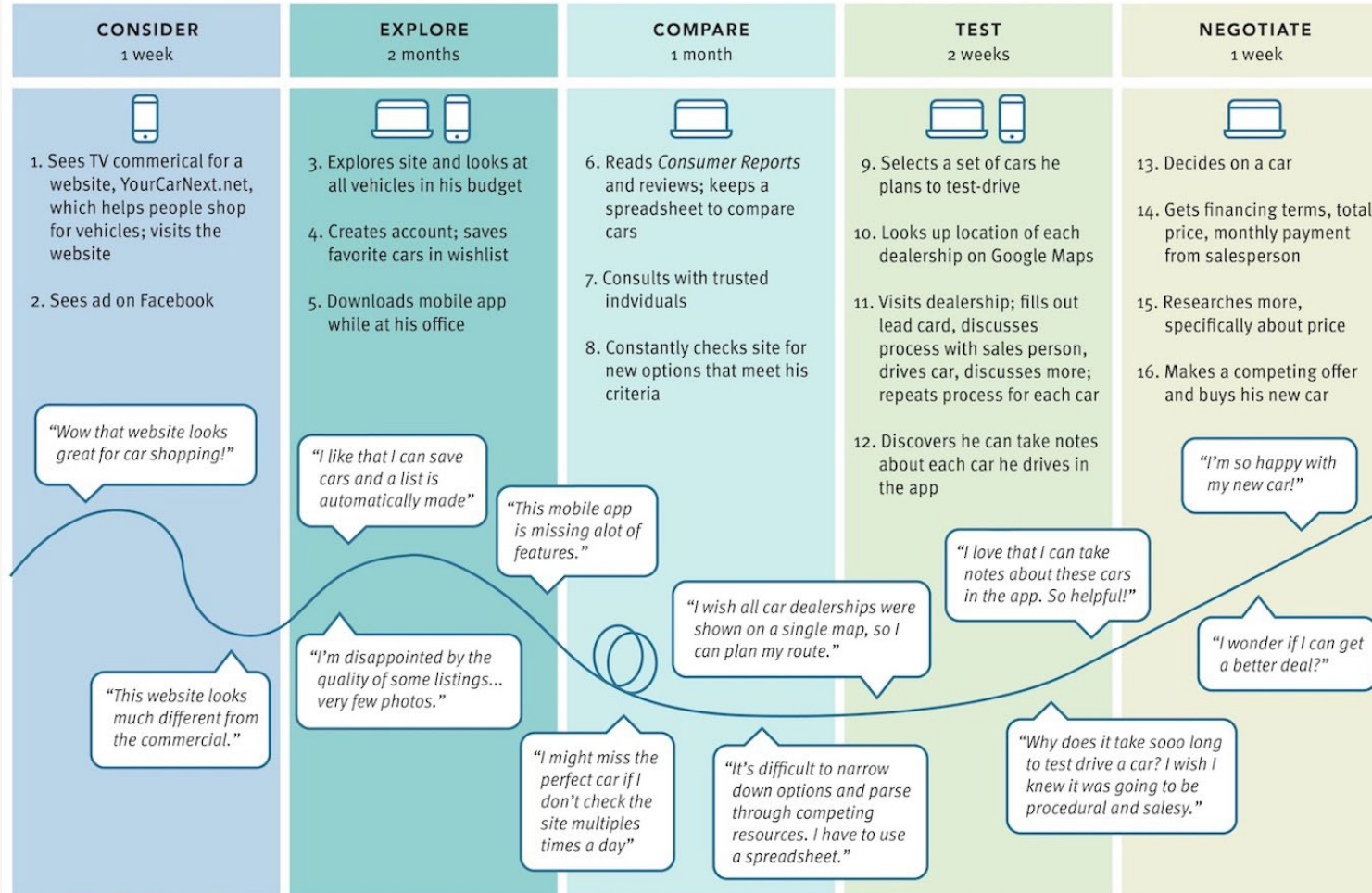


EMOTIONAL ERIC

Eric is an emotional car buyer. He purchases based on aesthetics and status.
Scenario: Eric recently moved to the area. He is shopping for a car that is fun to drive and dependable enough for use for everyday commuting.

EXPECTATIONS

- Ability to compare cars and their breakdowns
- Good photography with closeups, inside and out
- Video overview of car with demonstrations



User Journey Maps in **user research**

- ‘As is’ or ‘Current’ User Journey Maps document what users do now.
- They are based on data you have collected.
- They can represent a single user or an aggregation of users.
- They can be used to find problems and opportunities.

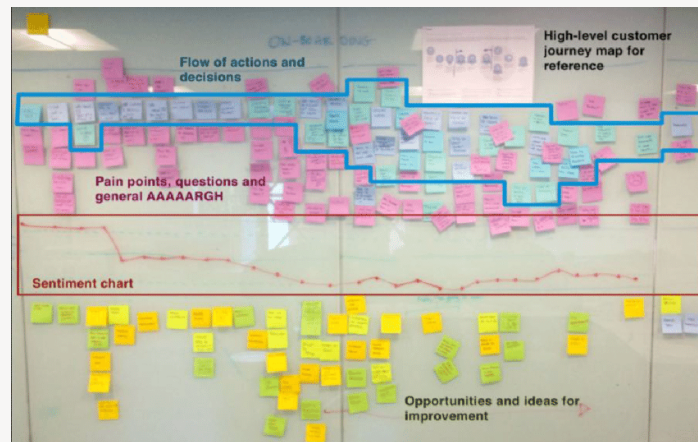


Image: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/337731093_Adjusting_customer_journey_mapping_for_application_in_industrial_product-service_systems/

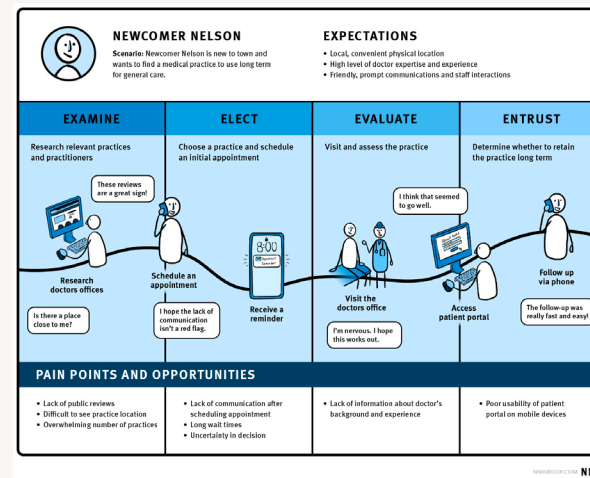


Image: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/user-journeys-vs-user-flows/>



Image: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/user-journeys-vs-user-flows/>

Collecting data for User Journey Maps

- Observations
- Interviews
- Diary studies
- Support logs

Creating a User Journey Map

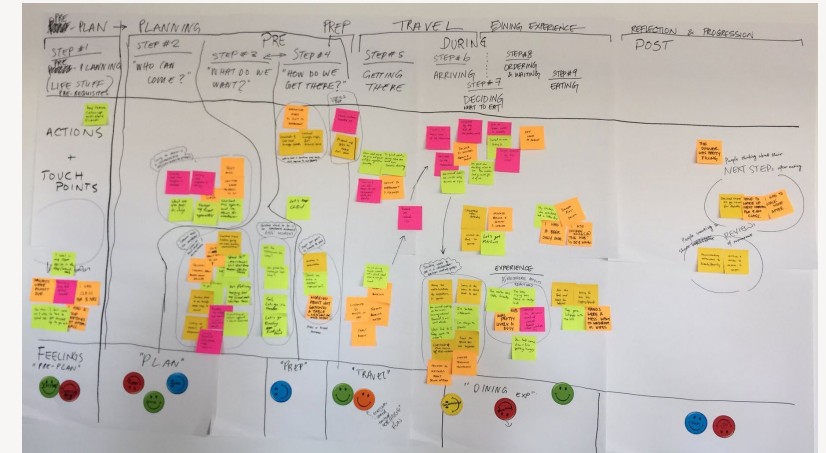
- Some User Journey Maps may look very polished
 - But, they often don't start off like that.
- It's better to **start rough**—there's a lot to work out.
- You might even begin with a sketch.
- Workshop it, with other people, or alone.
- Sticky notes are particularly good.
- Remember to **iterate**.
- Digital tools and templates do exist... if needed.



Image: <https://www.degruyter.com/document/doi/10.1515/icom-2016-0010/html>

Creating a User Journey Map

- Who is the **user**?
- What is the user goal you want to map?
 - What is the **scope** and **level of detail**?
 - Broadly, where does the journey **start**, and where does it **end**?
- What are the **main phases**, based on what you know?
- What **tasks** and **activities** are carried out during this phases?
- What is the user interacting with? What are the **touchpoints**?
- What are they **thinking** or **feeling** during these activities?
- What are the **pain points**, **challenges**, **wins**?
- And, where might there be **opportunities** to improve or enhance the user's journey?





Christina the Junior UXer

"You need to feel like you're a part of [the UX community] regardless of what your level is."

Actor

Christina is a Paralegal for a large tech firm, but is unsatisfied with her current career path and is looking to pivot into a UX role. She has taken several online UX curriculums and has a small working portfolio.

Scenario

Career Growth Through Networking
Christina is seeking inclusive UX meetup groups that will help to grow her professional network and provide mentorship/upskilling opportunities in hopes of making her a better entry-level

Goals

To become a competitive candidate for junior level UX jobs.

Phase		Discover	Attend	Build Rapport	Upskill and Apply						
		Discover UX meetup groups and events in her area.	Attend meetups to build her professional network.	Follow-up with connections on LinkedIn, seek mentorship.	Leverage mentor's experience to upskill UX capabilities/portfolio.						
Doing		1 Researching UX groups and events on Meetup and other websites.	4 Attends in-person UX meetups featuring panels of tenured designers, and virtual portfolio reviews.	7 Follow-up with new connections on LinkedIn, scheduling time for in person chats over coffee.	10 Guidance provided by mentor results in a polished resume and renewed confidence when applying for junior UX jobs.						
		2 Taking part in online UX communities and discussion boards.	5 Networks with people both currently within the industry and others looking to break into the industry.	8 Over time, connections made turn into informal mentorships - portfolio review and the opportunity to shadow on a small project.							
		3 RSVPs for an upcoming virtual Austin UX meeting	6 Has great conversations, makes connections with people she resonates most with on LinkedIn.	9 Comments on another person's question							
Experience & Emotions	Positive										
	Neutral	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
	Negative										
Opportunities & Requirements		Calendar highlighting UX events for the month, including details around event topics, dates and times.	Education page including resources, articles, and tools	Entry level Volunteer Job Board	Mentorship program						

Guiding Principles

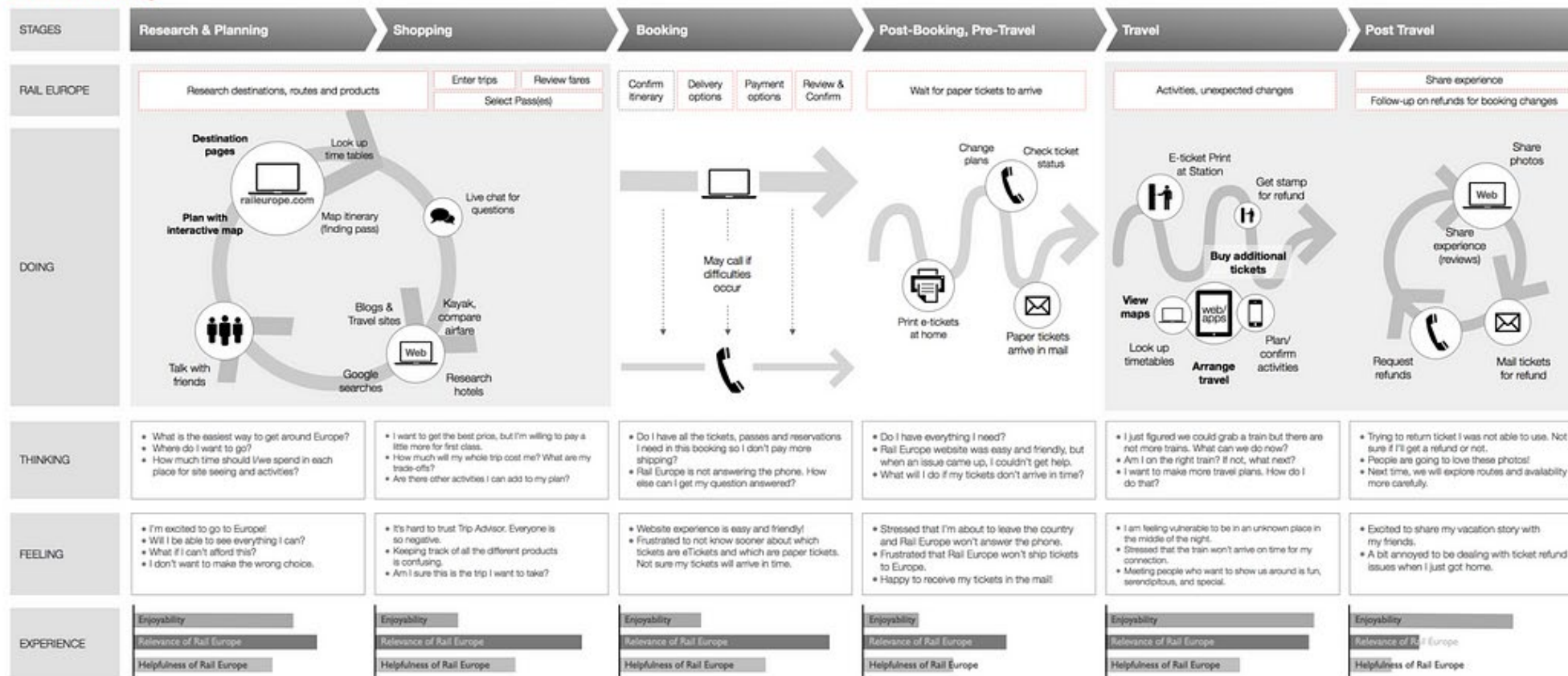
People choose rail travel because it is convenient, easy, and flexible.

Rail booking is only one part of people's larger travel process.

People build their travel plans over time.

People value service that is respectful, effective and personable.

Customer Journey



Opportunities

GLOBAL			PLANNING, SHOPPING, BOOKING			POST-BOOK, TRAVEL, POST-TRAVEL	
Communicate a clear value proposition.	Help people get the help they need.	Support people in creating their own solutions.	Enable people to plan over time.	Visualize the trip for planning and booking.	Arm customers with information for making decisions.	Improve the paper ticket experience.	Accommodate planning and booking in Europe too.
STAGE: Initial visit	STAGES: Global	STAGES: Global	STAGES: Planning, Shopping	STAGES: Planning, Shopping	STAGES: Shopping, Booking	STAGES: Post-Booking, Travel, Post-Travel	STAGE: Traveling
Make your customers into better, more savvy travelers.	Engage in social media with explicit purposes.		Connect planning, shopping and booking on the web.	Aggregate shipping with a reasonable timeline.		Proactively help people deal with change.	Communicate status clearly at all times.
STAGES: Global	STAGES: Global		STAGES: Planning, Shopping, Booking	STAGE: Booking		STAGES: Post-Booking, Traveling	STAGES: Post-Booking, Post-Travel

Information sources

Stakeholder interviews
Cognitive walkthroughs

Customer Experience Survey
Existing Rail Europe Documentation



Ongoing, non-linear



Linear process



Non-linear, but time based



Alexander's Experience Map

Role: Founder of AdventureTrap & business owner

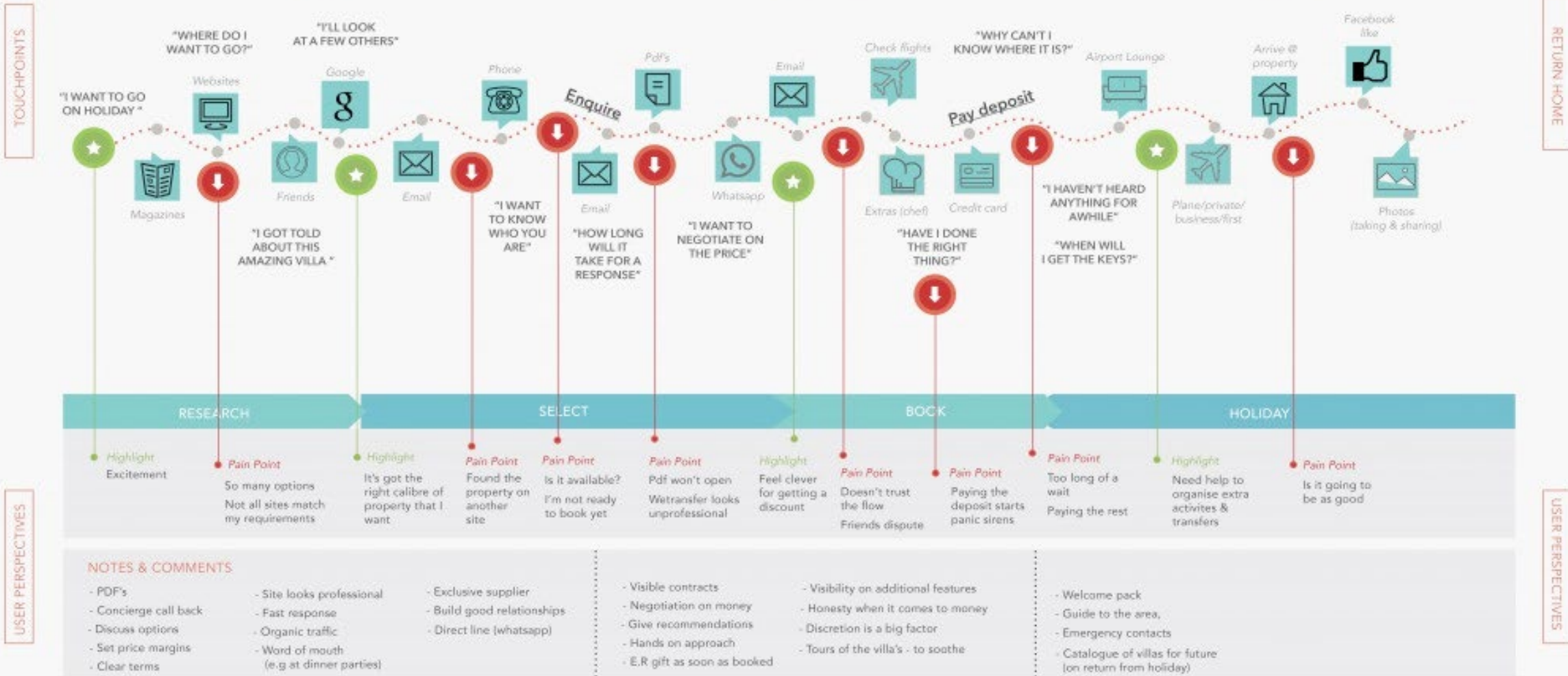
Age: 45 Relationship: Married with 2 children under 12

Background: Founded his company at the age of 22 and now owns two small businesses

"I want you to organise everything- boat, driver, chef - give me options"

"This is my budget- find me something nice"

"I don't know who you are, so I'm not going to book with you"



Current User Journey: *Susanne's motivations and experience now*

Susanne's Current Journey Map

Visiting the Barbican Library to spend time reading magazines

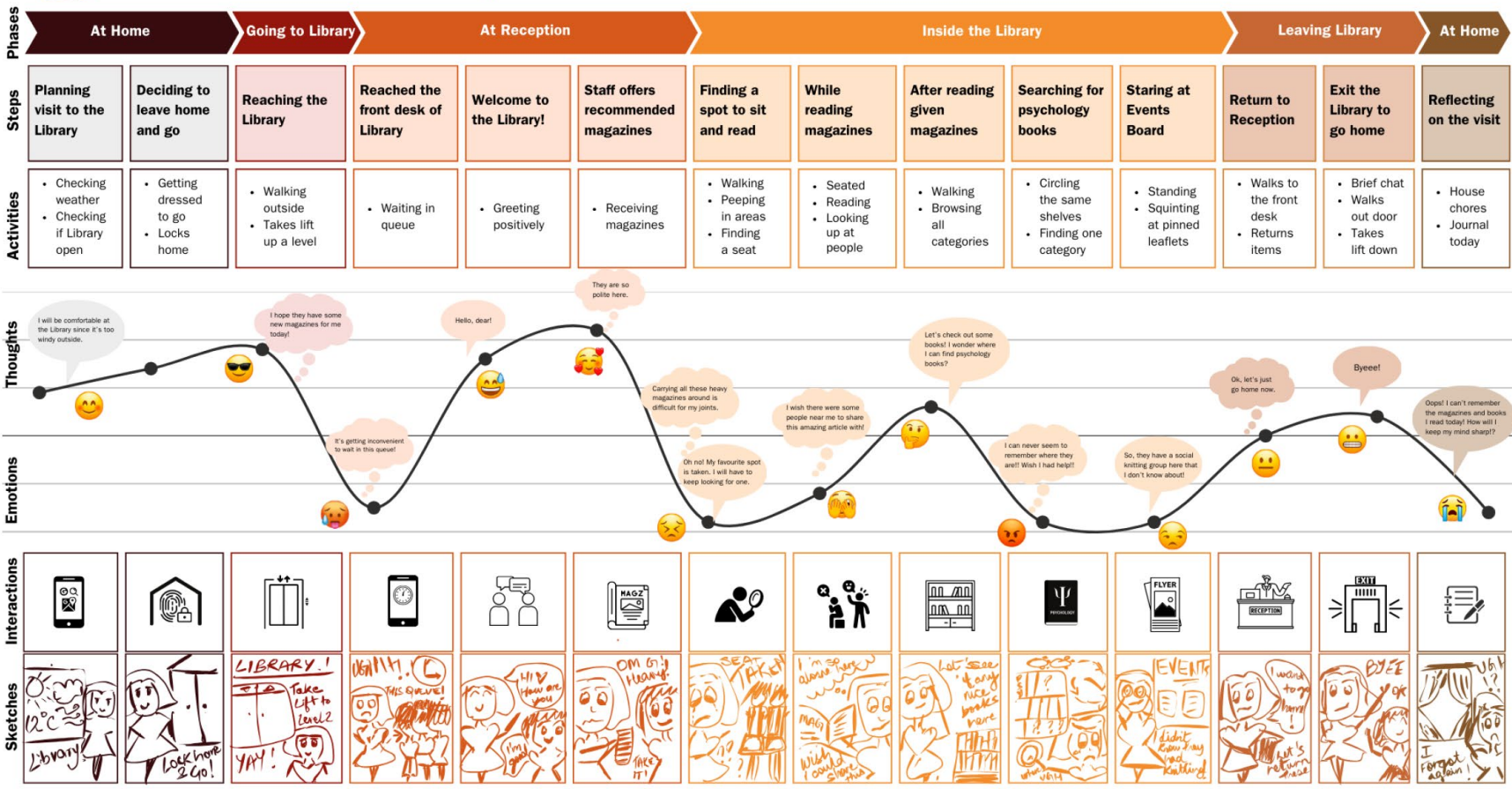


Barbican Patron, Susanne

- Inspired by art, books and magazines
- Comfortable at the Library

Motivations:

- Sense of calmness and community
- Stay updated about activities and events
- Practice and keep memory sharp
- Convenience in finding way



- Opportunities:**
- Check in experience
 - Location of categories / bookshelves
 - Searching for a sociable spot
 - Awareness of events and activities

Created by previous students

User Journey Maps: **some pros and cons**

Pros

- Useful communication tool
- Visual overview of an entire journey, end-to-end
- Help us understand user tasks, behaviour, needs, expectations.
- Flexible: scope, detail, refinement...
- Good for identifying pain points, gaps and opportunities, based on actual user data.

Cons / watchpoints

- Only as good as the data they're based on.
- Not one-size-fits-all—one persona / user type, one goal.
- Risk of focusing them more on the company/touchpoints than the user.
- Need to review and keep up to date.

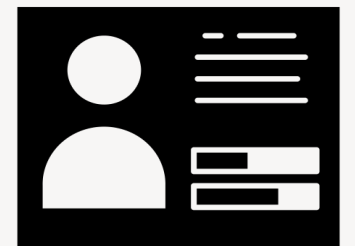
Adapted from: Walter, S. (2022). *User Journey Mapping*

Questions?



Analysing & representing data

Personas



Personas

Personas

- Concrete representations of anticipated users.
- They represent **distinct types of users for a specific product**.
- They are typically **synthesised from data collected about real people**.
- **Differentiated in terms of needs and behaviours**, not trivial or superficial characteristics.
- They are represented as individual people, to build empathy (but they aren't real people)
- Information in them should be **actionable**—relevant, useful and usable for the project you're doing.
- **Important:** Not just a summary of all the data you collected!

Jill Anderson



"I'm looking for a site that will simplify the planning of my business trips."

AGE: 35

WORK: Regional Director

FAMILY: Married, 1 Child

LOCATION: Austin, Tx

ARCHETYPE: The Frequent Flyer

Organized

Practical

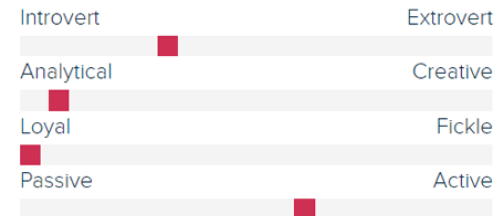
Protective

Hardworking

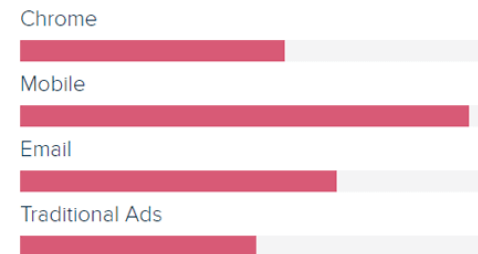
Bio

Jill is a Regional Director who travels 4-8 times each month for work. She has a specific region in which she travels, and she often visits the same cities and stays at the same hotel. She is frustrated by the fact that no matter how frequently she takes similar trips, she spends hours of her day booking travel. She expects her travel solutions to be as organized as she is.

Personality



Preferred Channels



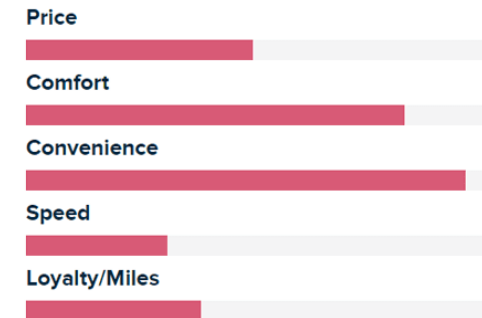
Goals

- To spend less time booking travel
- To narrow her options quickly

Frustrations

- Too much time spent booking - she's busy!
- Too many websites visited per trip
- Not terribly tech savvy - doesn't like the process

Motivations



Brands



From: <https://xtensio.com/user-persona>

Key aspects of personas

- Represent user groups.
- “**Composite archetypes**”—based on data gathered from multiple individuals (through interviews, observations, etc.)
- Don’t design to meet everyone’s needs—design to the needs of specific, main user groups that you can identify with personas.
- Means you have to identify the users that best represent key “groups” and then prioritise among these groups.
- **Differentiated in terms of needs and behaviours**, not trivial or superficial characteristics.
- And you want the information in them to be **actionable**—relevant, useful and usable for the project you’re doing.

Persona **types**

- You should create a persona for each major user group.
 - Often a **primary** and a **secondary** persona.
 - Try to keep the number of personas to a minimum.
- **Antipersonas** can be used to represent undesirable users (e.g. who would do the system harm or could be harmed by the system).
- **Proto personas**:
 - Hypothesis about a user type, to guide initial thinking, make assumptions explicit, identify gaps in knowledge
 - Validated / adjusted / replaced later through user research

Using personas

Why create personas?

So that you can use them in design:

1. As the 'user' in user journey maps—current and future
2. As a focus of ideation sessions, guiding design.
3. For expert reviews of prototypes (evaluation without real users).

What is in a persona?

Typically:

- A person's goals / motivations (relevant to the new product).
- Frustrations, pain points they currently face.
- Factors that might influence their behaviour with the system: experience, opinions, disabilities, environments of use .
- Details to enrich: name, image, social history, quote(s), etc.

Watchpoints:

- ! Keep it relevant—everything should be useful for the design of the product.
- ! Don't bloat them with irrelevant detail—focus on what's important / useful.
- ! Watch out for stereotyping, and potential for bias.

Persona **goals and tasks**

Personas often include goals and tasks. One informs the other.

Goals: The things users want to achieve.

Tasks: The smaller activities they need to achieve their goals.

Alan Cooper says it can be useful to consider different types of goals that might influence your target users:

Experience goals: How they want to feel while using the product e.g. smart, confident, in control, have fun, etc.

End goals: Motivation behind task e.g. stay connected with friends and family, clear to-do list before weekend.

Life goals: Why they want to achieve in life, e.g. succeed in their job, be respected by their peers.

You don't need to explicitly state goal *types* within your personas, just keep them in mind.



BACKGROUND

AGE	27
LOCATION	San Francisco
MARITAL STATUS	Single, boyfriend
KIDS	None
OCCUPATION	UX Designer
SALARY	\$95K
EDUCATION	Bachelor's

CHARACTERISTICS

Active person (gym, yoga)
Loves traveling
Easy going
Semi-organized
Likes to plan

"YOUNG PROFESSIONAL"

Kelly

TECH KNOWLEDGE

LITTLE EXPERT

SPENDING HABITS

FRUGAL LAVISH

BOOKING PREFERENCES

LOWEST FARE MOST IDEAL FLIGHT

ABOUT KELLY

Kelly is an active person who enjoys traveling to new destinations whenever she can. She tries to plan one trip abroad each year, as well as shorter getaways to nearby locations. She has three weeks of vacation that she will ideally spend away from home. She mainly travels with her boyfriend, but occasionally with a small group of friends. Kelly makes a decent salary so she isn't entirely budget conscious, but she isn't an extravagant spender either. She often weighs options to see whether quality or price is more appealing.

GOALS/NEEDS

Wants to be aware of good flight deals
Wants to compare travel dates and times for the best price
Wants to be able to use miles or points toward travel bookings
Prefers one airline for domestic travel



SHAIMA KHALED

Age 26
Location Casablanca, Morocco
Education BSc of Computer Science
Job Title Front-end Web Developer

“

I need to allocate some time for me to read; it's usually in the evening but I get carried away. Without following a routine or a reminder, I am unsuccessful getting on this habit.”

Reading Habits

Usually doesn't finish a book.
Prefers physical books over e-books.
Reads 0-2 books in a year.

Goals

Develop a reading habit.
Improve her communication skills.
Be valued and accepted in her community.

Frustrations

Can't find time to read a book, but also thinks it's a matter of discipline.
Doesn't know which book can interest her.
Lack of motivation to
Doesn't understand some of the ideas the author is trying to convey.

Frequently Used Apps





Drew

Influencer

ABOUT

Age 25-34

\$50K-75K

High Tech Proficiency

EVENT ATTENDANCE ATTRIBUTES

Frequent event go-ers (monthly), tend to be very early planners, and more likely to travel regionally or nationally for an event, tend to go to trending events only.

EVENT INFLUENCERS

Friends

Cultural

Adventure

Learning

Networking

Hype

Credibility

MOTIVATIONS

Motivated to find new things to do and share them with network, having influence, being the first to know about something and getting tickets right away.

CORE NEEDS

Finding events on social media and being able to easily share them. Being able to see trending events that will up their klout. Also getting notificatinos of on-sale so they can be the first to get tickets.

PAIN POINTS

Finding the time to attend events and staying on budget.

39%

Total Universe GTV

12

Events per month

*GTV Calculated based on # of Users x Frequency of Events.
Based on a study conducted with 115 participants.



AGE 27
JOB TITLE Procurement Analyst
STATUS In Relationship
LOCATION Austin, Texas

PSYCHOGRAPHICS

"we are a society that is always in a hurry and trying to get things done and don't take the time to keep track of simple things like our plastic consumption or recycling"

ABOUT

Daniel works full-time as a Procurement Analyst. His demanding job and lack of availability foster his consumption of convenient products, such as food take-out and plastic packaged products. Educated on the importance of recycling, he tries his best to make environmentally-friendly decisions when presented with the option, but does not prioritize it.

KNOWN HABITS

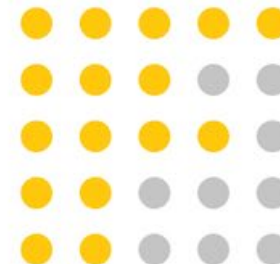
- Tries to recycle as much as possible, especially if it is convenient
- Uses a lot of single use plastic and containers
- Is aware of the current environmental situations occurring in the world

GOALS

- Have a positive impact on the environment and reduce his carbon footprint
- Finding a methodology to make recycling easier and habitual
- Learn more about the impacts of plastic consumption and how to improve his habits

PREFERENCES

- Exercise
- Console Games
- Reading
- Virtual Reality Games
- Board Games



FAVORITE BRANDS



PAIN POINTS

- Lack of plastic alternatives does not align with his desire to conserve the environment
- Unsure about the different grades of plastic, what is considered recyclable and what's not
- Plastic consumption is inevitable due to the large amount of products made of it



Marcus

**UX Researcher • Small Company
Works Remotely • Has Small Team**

About

Marcus is a UX designer who works for a company of 45-50 people. He has a small team and considers himself a UX generalist, so he conducts research in addition to designing interfaces and new digital products.

“It feels just like I'm shoehorning tools together to create this way to do it. And that just feels kind of clunky and overly complex.”

Environment & Context

- **Home:** Often works from home, where family can be loud. Worries about interruptions from roommates.
- **Team Meetings:** Has to present his work to his team and stakeholders. Wants to make a good impression, so he prepares a solid presentation.
- **Work:** Feels like he's constantly asking and fighting for tools to make his job easier.

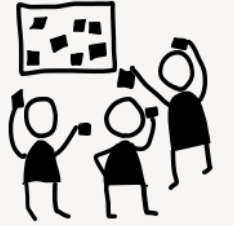
Goals & Needs

- Reduce the awkwardness of remote interviews, testing
- Find participants more easily
- Reduce the time to analyze and synthesize research findings
- Figure out a way to seamlessly move from tool to tool
- Ensure that he doesn't have to repeat research because of bad technology, like internet connectivity

Hesitations & Pain Points

- Connectivity -- participant internet varies widely, and it's not predictable
- Process -- reading intro and moving to testing scripts doesn't feel like a natural process online
- Analysis -- transcribing the data is manual and sometimes difficult if recording wasn't good
- Collaboration -- not easy to communicate with teammates during interview, testing

Creating personas



1. **Collect data about users:** Who are they and what do they want to achieve? What do they typically do? What are their pain points? etc.
2. **Analyse the data:** Look for themes/characteristics that recur and are relevant to the design activity. Affinity mapping can be very useful for this.
3. **Brainstorm:** Organise elements into persona groups that represent your target users. Name or classify each group.
4. **Refine:** Combine and prioritise the rough personas. Separate them into primary, secondary personas.
5. **Humanise them:** Add image, name, quote(s) from user data, and any additional detail deemed relevant.
 - But, do not include a lot of *irrelevant* personal information or demographics. Also watch out for stereotyping.

Personas: some **resources**

- Babich (2017) [*Putting Personas to Work in UX Design: What They Are and Why They're Important*](#) (article).
- Shestopalov (2019) [*Make Your Personas Great Again in 7 Simple Steps - Less Decoration, More Data*](#) (article)—I advise reading this before creating any personas.
- Sharp, Rogers & Preece (2023) Section 11.5 [*Bringing Requirements to Life: Personas and Scenarios*](#). In *Interaction Design*, 6th Edition (book section).
- Dam and Siang (2024) [*Personas – A Simple Introduction*](#) (article).
- Stickdorn, Hormess, Lawrence & Schneider (2019) [*'Creating Personas'*](#) in Chapter 5 of *This is Service Design Doing* (book section).

Some **strengths** of personas

- Help determine what a design should do and how it should behave.
- Communicate with other stakeholders.
- Build consensus and commitment.
- Measure the design's effectiveness.
- Avoids the *elastic user* and *self-referential designs*.
- Useful for recruitment—personas represent target user types.

Some **drawbacks** of personas?

- They take effort to produce, and it's not easy to create good ones.
- Can become outdated
- They need to encapsulate data and detail relevant for the project
 - Personas that don't provide **the right data to make the necessary design decisions**, will be ineffective and can even mislead.
 - Watch out when using a template—are the categories and dimensions of information relevant for your project?
 - Over-abundance of unnecessary detail can obscure, distract or detract from useful information.
 - Poor choices can lead to stereotyping and bias.
- Personas aren't real users. Recognise their limits.

“Make Your Personas Great Again in 7 Simple Steps”



Name

~~John Rockefeller~~

Position

Head of Product

Location

London, UK

Industry

IT

~~Income~~

~~\$100-120k~~

Age

~~28-35~~

~~Marital status~~

~~Married~~

Goals

- Build product strategy
- Maintain product profitability
- Release product features
- Forecast problems with a product and find the ways to resolve them

Needs

- Invest in right product features
- Define the requirements and formulate acceptance criteria
- Orchestrate design, development, business, and other processes

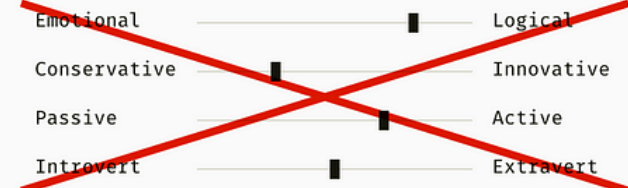
Interests

- ~~Yachting~~
- ~~Sportcars~~
- ~~Golf~~
- ~~Fitness~~

Quote

~~“Building and launching cutting edge IT products is my life.”~~

Character



Social networks



Brands



<https://medium.com/design-bridges/personas-e60c1c06ead1>

Questions?



Session 4 **summary**

- Explored how to analyse data from user research, e.g. through simple thematic analysis, and affinity diagramming.
- Learned to create artefacts such as empathy maps, user journey maps and personas, to represent the findings from user research.
- Learned that the desire to create these artefacts (representations) drives the data that you collect.